

Section A: Issues in mental health (compulsory)

Section A: Issues in mental health			
Topic	Background	Key research	Application
The historical context of mental health	- Historical views of mental illness - Defining abnormality - Categorising mental disorders	Rosenhan (1973) On being sane in insane places.	Characteristics of an affective disorder, a psychotic disorder and an anxiety disorder.
The medical model	- The biochemical explanation of mental illness - The genetic explanation of mental illness - Brain abnormality as an explanation of mental illness	Gottesman et al. (2010) Disorders in offspring with two psychiatrically ill parents.	Biological treatment of one specific disorder.
Alternatives to the medical model	- The behaviourist explanation of mental illness - The cognitive explanation of mental illness One from: - the humanistic explanation of mental illness - the psychodynamic explanation of mental illness - the cognitive neuroscience explanation of mental illness.	Szasz (2011) The myth of mental illness: 50 years later.	Non-biological treatment of one specific disorder.

For full references please see Appendix 5f.